Minutes of the
General Government Committee Meeting
Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall and Electronically
At 1:00 p.m. on May 8, 2023

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Chair – Regional Councillor	S. Lee
	Regional Councillor	M. Crawford
	Councillors	L. Bower
		N. Henry
		R. Tyler Morin
	Mayor	S. Collier
Regrets:	Regional Councillor	J. Dies

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Chair Lee called the meeting to order at 1:01 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interests.

3. Adoption of Minutes

3.1 Regular Meeting

Moved by: L. Bower

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held on April 11, 2023 be adopted.

CARRIED

4. Consent Agenda

Members separated items 4.1, 4.2, 4.3, 4.6, 4.8, 4.9, 4.11, 4.12, 4.13 and 4.14 for discussion.

4.1 CAO-2023-07: Social Media Policy Update

Committee Members asked questions regarding social media sharing, tagging permissions, management and administration of personal and constituent-facing social media accounts, social media policies among area municipalities, application of Council's Code of Conduct, requirements for the Town to adopt a social media policy, strategies to mitigate disrespectful behaviour, administering social media groups, protections available to Council Members, notification requirements related to moderating and blocking, and consultation with the Integrity Commissioner regarding provisions set out in the policy. Devon Jarvis, Supervisor of Communications & Engagement, Shane Baker, Chief Administrative Officer, and Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative & Information Services/Clerk, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: S. Collier

That the proposed update to Social Media Policy 055 (ATT-1) of the addition of section 3.3. *Management and Administration – Council Member Accounts* be approved.

Motion to Refer

Moved by: N. Henry

That amendments to the social media policy be referred to the Integrity Commissioner for their review and input respecting the application of Council's Code of Conduct and that staff report back to Council in September 2023.

CARRIED

4.2 **CAO-2023-09: 2023 Council Member Remuneration**

Committee Members asked questions regarding compensation for the Deputy Mayor, rationale for advances in the Deputy Mayor's role, annual salary namely if Council has a conflict of interest given Council approved the CUPE Collective Agreement, and impacts to Council salaries if CUPE negotiations are not settled. S. Baker and N. Cooper, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

That the attached 2023 Council Remuneration By-Law be brought forward to the May 15, 2023 Council Meeting for approval.

That the Clerk be directed to take the necessary steps to ensure that the Deputy Mayor role in Ajax is properly defined within the relevant Town by-laws and/or policies, and report back to Council for related approvals as necessary.

CARRIED

4.3 **FIN-2023-07: 2022 Cash in Lieu of Parkland, Cash in Lieu of Parking and Community Benefits Charge – Annual Statement**

Committee Members sought clarification regarding Town utilized Section 37 Community Benefits Charge developments. Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, responded to the question.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

That the report "2022 Cash in Lieu of Parkland, Cash in Lieu of Parking and Community Benefits Charge - Annual Statement" be received for information.

CARRIED

4.4 FIN-2023-08: 2022 Canada Community-Building Fund Annual Report

Moved by: S. Collier

That the report "2022 Canada Community-Building Fund Annual Report" be received for information.

CARRIED

4.5 FIN-2023-09: 2022 Development Charge Reserve Funds – Treasurer's Annual Statement

Moved by: S. Collier

That the report "2022 Development Charge Reserve Funds – Treasurer's Annual Statement" be received for information.

CARRIED

4.6 FIN-2023-10: 2022 Operating Results and Year-end Reserve Allocations

Committee Members asked questions regarding non-realized capital gains calculations and opportunities to capture target balances and surplus allocations for all reserves. Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the report on the 2022 Operating Results be received for information.

2. That Council approve the following 2022 Year End Allocations to Reserves, as recommended by the Director of Finance in accordance with the Financial Sustainability Plan:

Reserve	Allocation
Capital Contingency Reserve	$ 1,277,686
Vehicle & Equipment Reserve	$ 1,989,700
Building Maintenance Reserve	$ 1,647,481
Development Reserve	$ 930,000
Strategic Initiatives Reserve	$ 401,200

CARRIED

4.7 FIN-2023-11: Capital Account Closing Report, March 31, 2023

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That Council receive the attached listing of Capital Account closings as of March 31st, 2023 for information.

2. That funding transfers to/from the Reserves/Reserve Funds from the March 31st, 2023 Capital Account Closings, in accordance with the Financial Sustainability Plan, and changes in project funding sources as described in this report, be approved as follows:

Reserve / Reserve Fund	Transfers to	Transfers from	Net Transfers
Capital Contingency Reserve	($41,876.99)	$56,472.70	$14,595.71
Building Maintenance Reserve	($118,271.60)	$41,686.37	($76,585.23)
General Infrastructure Reserve	($148,901.70)	$35,491.06	($113,410.64)
Strategic Initiatives Reserve	($209,076.65)	-	($209,076.65)
Roads Maintenance Reserve	-	$20,355.47	$20,355.47
Vehicle/Equipment Replacement Reserve	($14,486.16)	$42,775.16	$28,289.00
Development Reserve	($118,158.01)	$3,954.06	($114,203.95)
Stormwater Maintenance Reserve	($24,147.02)	-	($24,147.02)
Development Charges 2018	-	$17,541.75	$17,541.75
Total Transfers	**($674,918.13)**	**$ 218,276.57**	**($456,641.56)**

3. That the over-expenditure of $7,448.81 (net of HST rebate) on 1014411 Automated Speed Enforcement, previously awarded to Signalisation Kalitec on May 10, 2021 by Council, be received for information.

CARRIED

4.8 AFES-2023-02: Contract Award – Supply & Delivery – Pumper/Rescue Fire Truck

Committee Members asked questions regarding financing options and rationale for funds allocated to contingency and travel. D. Valentim and Aaron Burridge, Interim Fire Chief, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: L. Bower

1. That council award the contract for the supply and delivery of a Pumper/Rescue Fire Truck to Commercial Emergency Equipment in the amount of $1,521,611.67 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That council approve funding of $36,158.43 to be allocated to Capital No. 1032411 from the Vehicle/Equipment Replacement Reserve.

CARRIED

4.9 **OES-2023-16: Contract Award – Range Line Road Reconstruction from Pickering Beach Road to Shoal Point Road**

Committee Members asked questions regarding sidewalk continuity on Range Line Road, drainage infrastructure, cycling infrastructure, multi-use path considerations, project costs, project scope, project timelines, and communication strategies. Ranil Fernando, Manager of Infrastructure & Asset Management, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: L. Bower

1. That Council award the contract for Range Line Road Reconstruction from Pickering Beach Road to Shoal Point Road including mill and overlay of Shoal Point Road to Dufferin Construction Company in the amount of $3,444,333.79 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That Council approve funding of $1,817,295.24, to be allocated from the following Capital Accounts from the Canada Community Building Fund:

1034011 – Range Line Resurfacing – Cherry Road to Shoal Point Road	$1,821,711.96
1034111 – Range Line Recons - Pickering Beach Road to Cherry Road	($ 4,416.72)
Total	$ 1,817,295.24

3. That Council award the contract for the Contract Administration and Material Testing to R.V. Anderson in the amount of $290,797.31 (inclusive of all taxes) for the Range Line Road Reconstruction project.

CARRIED

4.10 **OES-2023-12: Contract Award – Buried Streetlight System Replacement**

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That Council award the contract for Buried Streetlight System Replacement, to Hastings Utilities Contracting Ltd. in the amount of $736,308.00 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That Council award the contract for Contract Administration ~ Buried Streetlight System Replacement, to Morrison Hershfield Limited in the amount of $42,250.70 (inclusive of all taxes).

CARRIED

4.11 **OES-2023-17: Removal/Replacement of Digital Screens**

Committee Members asked questions regarding project scope, project costs, alternative options, costs associated with the removal of digital screens, and opportunities to relocate the Welcome sign at Westney Road/Highway 2. Dave Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services and S. Baker, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That Council award the contract for the removal and/or replacement of four (4) digital screens, to Provincial Sign Systems in the estimated amount of $152,098.00 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That Council approve funding of $148,060.00 to be allocated to a Capital Account from Capital Contingency Reserve.

CARRIED

Amendment

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the sign at the intersection of Highway 2/Westney Road be non-illuminated.

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That Council award the contract for the removal and/or replacement of four (4) digital screens, to Provincial Sign Systems in the estimated amount of $152,098.00 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That Council approve funding of $148,060.00 to be allocated to a Capital Account from Capital Contingency Reserve.

3. That the sign at the intersection of Highway 2/Westney Road be non-illuminated.

CARRIED

4.12 **PDS-2023-19: Review of Underutilized Town Facilities Update**

Committee Members asked questions regarding lease criteria framework, status of the Innovation Program, opportunities to utilize Sundial Sales Pavilion for the Makerspace, appraised values, rental rates, highest and best use of Hartrick House, size of subject lands, operating and capital costs, property appraisal process, scope of work for Quaker Meeting House, opportunities to include an affordable housing condition in an Agreement of Purchase & Sale, opportunities to amend current zoning and permitted uses, and the current condition, current use and capacity of Sundial Sales Pavilion. Samuel Twumasi, Manager of Economic Development, G. Romanowski, S. Baker, D. Meredith, and Chris Vida, Director of Recreation & Culture, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

1. That the report titled “Underutilized Facilities Report Update” be received for information;

2. That Council direct staff to maintain Hartrick House based on current usage and expand promotion to better maximize usage during weekdays;

3. That staff be directed to report back following the approval of the Arts and Cultural Plan, on the long-term usage of the Sundial Sales Pavilion space.

CARRIED

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That the motion be amended by adding the following:

That staff prepare a fulsome report identifying capital costs, maintenance costs, projected and incurred costs (3-years), highest and best use of residential usage, including affordable housing, on all 8 properties being:

- Hartrick House (120 Roberson Drive)
- Greenwood House (2280 Greenwood Road)
- Greenwood Pavilion
- Central Park Ajax Sales Pavilion (Ajax Plaza)
- Mill Street Firehall (25 Mill Street)
- Sundial Sales Pavilion (99 Barnham Street)
- Quaker Meeting House - Basement Level (457 Kingston Road)
- Village Library (58 Church Street North)

And report back to Council immediately following the approval of the Arts and Cultural Plan on these building capital and maintenance costs past and future as well as revenues from permitting.

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

1. That the report titled “Underutilized Facilities Report Update” be received for information;

2. That Council direct staff to maintain Hartrick House based on current usage and expand promotion to better maximize usage during weekdays;

3. That staff be directed to report back following the approval of the Arts and Cultural Plan, on the long-term usage of the Sundial Sales Pavilion space; and

4. That staff prepare a fulsome report identifying capital costs, maintenance costs, projected and incurred costs (3-years), highest and best use of residential usage, including affordable housing, on all 8 properties being:

    - Hartrick House (120 Roberson Drive)
    - Greenwood House (2280 Greenwood Road)
    - Greenwood Pavilion

- Central Park Ajax Sales Pavilion (Ajax Plaza)
- Mill Street Firehall (25 Mill Street)
- Sundial Sales Pavilion (99 Barnham Street)
- Quaker Meeting House - Basement Level (457 Kingston Road)
- Village Library (58 Church Street North)

And report back to Council immediately following the approval of the Arts and Cultural Plan on these building capital and maintenance costs past and future as well as revenues from permitting.

CARRIED

Committee recessed at 3:13 p.m.

Committee resumed at 3:20 p.m.

4.13 **LIS-2023-09: Updates to Noise By-law**

Committee Members asked questions regarding communication strategies, dog barking provisions, enforcement mechanisms, and response times. Derek Hannan, Manager of By-law Services, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the proposed updated Noise By-law (ATT-1) be brought forward to the May 15, 2023 meeting of Council for approval.

CARRIED

4.14 **LIS-2023-10: Updates to Public Nuisance and Safety By-law**

Committee Members asked questions regarding intoxication provisions, penalty and enforcement processes, impacts and risks to short term rental property owners, communication strategies, and if provisions for bonfires at the waterfront are included. N. Cooper and D. Hannan, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: N. Henry

That the proposed updated Public Nuisance and Safety By-law (ATT-1) be brought forward to the May 15, 2023 meeting of Council for approval.

CARRIED

5. Discussion

5.1 **OES-2023-15: Snow Removal Program for Seniors and Qualified Residents**

Committee Members asked questions regarding personal injury claims on private property, Service Level 2 costs, justifications for reduced service levels, number of registered residents receiving Level 1 vs Level 2 services, consultation with current program users and the Age Friendly Committee, program inception date, risk management, years enrolled in the insurance pool, service levels offered by surrounding municipalities, contracted services, opportunities to subsidize costs, service delivery and

staff resources, and opportunities to introduce a liability waiver. D. Meredith, D. Valentim, and S. Baker, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

1. That staff be authorized to modify the current Snow Removal Program for Seniors and Qualified Residents to only include the clearing of windrows and municipal sidewalks;

2. That staff be authorized to recruit the required staffing and procure the required equipment to enable the service modifications in Recommendation 1, as detailed in this report; and

3. That new staffing costs be managed through the operating budget management policy, and included as new seasonal Part time staff in the 2024 operating budget.

Motion to Refer

Moved by: N. Henry

That the report be referred back to staff to:

- Establish a revised Seniors Snow Clearing Program with service levels options and associated costing; and
- Once determined by staff, consult with the Accessibility Advisory Committee, Age Friendly Steering Committee and current program participants; and
- Consult with other municipalities to understand how they deliver snow clearing services and the subsidy level incurred by the municipality; and
- Report back to Committee in September 2023.

CARRIED

6. Presentations

6.1 Council Decision Dashboard Demo

Jason McWilliam, Manager of Legislative Services/Deputy Clerk, delivered a presentation regarding the Council Decision Dashboard. J. McWilliam provided an overview of the project and reviewed background, purpose, project scope, key enablers, the PowerBI platform, and benefits. J. McWilliam demonstrated features and functions of the Council Decision Dashboard.

Committee Members asked questions regarding search features and opportunities to collect non-tax revenues from other municipalities. J. McWilliam responded to questions from Committee Members.

There was no motion regarding this item.

6.2 OES-2023-02: Urban Forest Study Update – Technical Report

Tim Field, Manager of Environmental Services reviewed the contents of the written report

and recommendations contained therein. T. Field reviewed benefits of trees, study purpose, study area, urban forest and land cover distribution including trees in each land use category, comparisons between 2009 and 2022 including composition change and size distribution, future planting plans, and staff recommendations.

Committee Members asked questions regarding Town policies related to the destruction or removal of trees during the development process and available penalties for removing trees without permission. T. Field responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: M. Crawford

That Council endorse the Urban Forest Study Update – Technical Report prepared by the Toronto and Region Conservation Authority, dated March 24th, 2023.

CARRIED

6.3 PDS-2023-18: Community Improvement Plans Review: Program Recommendations

Michael Sawchuck, Senior Planner reviewed the contents of the written report and recommendations contained therein. M. Sawchuck reviewed Community Improvement Plan (CIP) background and work to date. M. Sawchuck discussed past and current direction on CIP amendments including effects of Bills 109 and 23 on CIPs, CIP area objectives, proposed Downtown CIP revisions, proposed Pickering Village CIP revisions, program profiles, funding considerations, CIP framework implementation, and staff recommendations.

Committee Members asked questions regarding status of rehabilitation in the Pickering Village Heritage Conservation District, opportunities to replace the Pickering Village sign through the Sign Grant Program, rationale for funding allocations, size, eligibility and projected uptake for the Downtown CIP, and future opportunities for funding allocations to businesses in North Ajax. M. Sawchuck responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: N. Henry

1. That staff be authorized to undertake the required consultation process to amend the Downtown and Pickering Village Community Improvement Plans to realign them with the Town's strategic objectives, as prescribed under Section 28(5) of the *Planning Act*;

2. That program suspensions under the Downtown and Pickering Village Community Improvement Plans be extended until December 31, 2023 (or to the date of approval for any amended Community Improvement Plan, whichever is sooner) for the following programs:

    a. Downtown Community Improvement Plan
        i. Rehabilitation Grant Program;
        ii. Planning and Development Fees Grant Program;
        iii. Development Charge Exemption/Grant Program;
        iv. Reduced Parkland Dedication Requirements Program;

    b. Pickering Village Community Improvement Plan
        i. Development Tax Rebate Program;

ii. Planning and Development Fees Rebate Program;
iii. Development Charge Exemption/Reduction Program;
iv. Reduced Parkland Dedication Requirements Program;

3. That unspent funds from future Downtown and Pickering Village CIP annual budgets be redirected to the CIP Development Improvement Fund, and that these funds be made available for future Town-led initiatives in either CIP area.

CARRIED

Amendment

Moved by: L. Bower

That the motion be amended by adding the following:

That any applications from within the Downtown CIP over the upset limit come to Council for approval.

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amendment

Moved by: N. Henry

1. That staff be authorized to undertake the required consultation process to amend the Downtown and Pickering Village Community Improvement Plans to realign them with the Town's strategic objectives, as prescribed under Section 28(5) of the *Planning Act*;

2. That program suspensions under the Downtown and Pickering Village Community Improvement Plans be extended until December 31, 2023 (or to the date of approval for any amended Community Improvement Plan, whichever is sooner) for the following programs:

   a. Downtown Community Improvement Plan
      i. Rehabilitation Grant Program;
      ii. Planning and Development Fees Grant Program;
      iii. Development Charge Exemption/Grant Program;
      iv. Reduced Parkland Dedication Requirements Program;

   b. Pickering Village Community Improvement Plan
      i. Development Tax Rebate Program;
      ii. Planning and Development Fees Rebate Program;
      iii. Development Charge Exemption/Reduction Program;
      iv. Reduced Parkland Dedication Requirements Program;

3. That unspent funds from future Downtown and Pickering Village CIP annual budgets be redirected to the CIP Development Improvement Fund, and that these funds be made available for future Town-led initiatives in either CIP area.

4. That any applications from within the Downtown CIP over the upset limit come to Council for approval.

CARRIED

7. Closed Session

None

8. Adjournment (5:10 p.m.)

Moved by: L. Bower

That the May 8, 2023 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.

CARRIED